moisture deficit recorded since the beginning of the rainy season, improving soil conditions and yield prospects for the *postrera* (September-December) and *apante* (December-February) seasons. However, in Honduras, the rains resulted in flooding, overflowing rivers and landslides, damaging crops and road and housing infrastructure, especially in the departments of the Atlantic coast, Santa Bárbara and Olancho. El Salvador reported agricultural damage in specific areas, especially to small farmers' bean crops due to the development of fungal diseases caused by high humidity. However, this was to a lesser extent than experienced in Honduras. In conclusion, Nicaraguan bean production will be close to average for the next two agricultural cycles - maintaining stability in regional supply - while the other two countries will see a decrease in *postrera* production, especially for subsistence farmers.

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- Despite a decrease in headline inflation in October, compared to September, in all three countries, it continues to be above average. However, prices remain well above those reported pre-pandemic. On the other hand, food inflation in El Salvador and Nicaragua showed an upward trend, breaking with the downward trajectory reported up to that point in the year. Atypical increases in the prices of basic grains and vegetables originated from difficulties in regional transportation due to road blockades caused by the political crisis in Guatemala, high production costs (particularly fertilizers and labor), lower expected production due to poor rainfall, and market speculation. Above-average prices are expected to persist, which will continue to make access to food more difficult for poor households.

- Coffee production in the region, an important cash crop and seasonal source of income, will decrease due to yield sensitivity to irregular rainfall. This, coupled with a decrease in the international selling price and an increase in production costs, will mean lower income for producers, especially small producers, limiting their access to food and investment in their livelihoods. Day laborers will not see an improvement in overall income over the previous year, despite the higher pay per day, due to a decrease in the total volume harvested. This will translate into lower household purchasing power for the beginning of the annual lean season.

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